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Submitter Information

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General Comment

Generative AI is not a race we need to concern ourselves with winning. Like NFTs or the "Meta-verse", it is a bubble whose benefits and capabilities have been wildly overstated by tech executives chasing investor cash and stock prices. The actual technology is unreliable, unsustainably expensive, wasteful to limited resources, and will become increasingly difficult to monetize as the public continues to grow more and more frustrated with how hard it's being pushed on us against our will.

More concerningly, companies are being given the green light to steal copyrighted material as training data. The models that fuel generative AI are constructed from widespread harvesting of text, photos, video, music, and even people's faces and voices. All to be regurgitated later at the discretion of companies who do not own this property and have no license to use it. This is, make no mistake, theft. And the attempt to replace the creators of these copyrighted works by stealing their property out from under them will not only open the door to an endless series of legal battles, but also directly threatens countless jobs in the fields that AI seeks to "replace". None of this provides personal, practical, creative, or economic benefit to the American people.

There is also a grave risk posed by the ease of misinformation this technology enables. Text based models like ChatGPT and Google's search summaries are notorious for providing laughably inaccurate information, information that may even prove dangerous if concerning vital topics such as medical advice. Companies open themselves up to extreme liability by positioning these automated systems as legitimate sources of information, and represent a direct risk to any members of the public who trust them to be so.

The potential for deliberate deception is even worse. There have already been phone scams using AI powered voice cloning, and the ability to convincingly mimic any person from a minimum of available data will have devastating interpersonal, professional, and even political consequences. Further escalation of generative AI will inevitably lead to, for example, an endless supply of videos of the President saying and doing compromising things that will be indistinguishable from real footage. Every public figure with enough cloneable data will become a target of the internet's whims, no matter how malicious, inappropriate, or damaging.

Generative AI is a solution in search of a problem. It's a technology begging for abuse and offering little in return but overinflated promises. The bubble is already popping. No amount of resources poured into it can stop that. Those resources are finite, and better spent on things that will actually directly help the public.